

Elevate 215 — Funder Reporting Workflow

Overview

This project explores the **funder reporting workflow at Elevate 215** and identifies opportunities to make the process easier, faster, and less dependent on manual coordination.

The project came from a discovery process focused on understanding how Elevate 215 gathers information when a funder asks:

“What did my money do?”

The research showed that the information needed to answer that question already exists, but it is spread across different people and places. The challenge is bringing those pieces together so the team can see **the whole story**.

About Elevate 215

Elevate 215 works to improve educational outcomes for Philadelphia students by increasing the number of high-quality schools.

The organization works across different parts of the education system, with a focus on understanding whether investments are **“moving the needle for kids.”**

The Problem

When a funder requests an update about their investment, Stacy has to bring together several pieces of information:

- **Renée** → School performance and visit notes
- **Stacy** → Grant agreement and reporting requirements
- **Priya** → Payment and financial information

The information exists, but it does not all live together.

As Stacy explained:

“Each of us owns a piece, but none of us own the whole story.”

She also described the dependency in the current process:

“I’m the process.”

The actual assembly can take about an hour once all the information is available, but the process can take **about a week from start to finish** because of waiting, follow-up, gathering, and checking.

Current Workflow

Funder asks:

“What did my money do?”



Stacy gathers information



Renée

School Notes



Grant Agreement



Priya

Payment Information



Wait for missing pieces



Stacy connects the information



Reviews + checks information



Writes response



Funder receives report

Main friction points

- Information is spread across multiple people and systems
 - Stacy has to coordinate the different pieces
 - The workflow depends on people responding before the process can move forward
 - Information may need to be checked for freshness
 - There is no single place to see the full story
 - The process can take about a week even though the actual assembly takes about an hour
-

Proposed Workflow

The proposed solution does **not** remove the people who own the information or take human judgment out of the process.

Instead, it focuses on connecting the existing information so the team can review it together.

Funder asks:

“What did my money do?”



Grant + School + Payment
information comes together



Information is reviewed
for freshness



Outdated / missing information
is flagged



If someone is unavailable:

- Alert the team
- Update the information
- Use the most recent available information
- Reroute review when needed



Stacy reviews the whole story



Stacy uses her judgment
+ writes response



Funder receives report

What Changes?

The biggest change is the shift from:

“Where is this information?”

to:

“Here’s the information I need. Now I can review it and respond.”

Instead of Stacy spending her time chasing down information from Renée, Priya, and others, the relevant information can be brought together for review.

The system could also:

- Flag information that has not been updated within a set amount of time
- Alert the appropriate person when an update is needed
- Help the team use the most recent available information when someone is unavailable

- Reroute a review if Stacy is unavailable
 - Keep the human review and decision-making process in place
-

Expected Impact

Less Waiting

The current process can take approximately **one week from start to finish**.

The proposed workflow focuses on reducing the waiting and coordination between each piece of information.

Less Dependency

The workflow currently depends heavily on Stacy coordinating information from different people.

The goal is to make the process easier for the entire team to navigate without requiring Stacy to personally hold all the pieces together.

Easier Review

Stacy can focus on:

- Reviewing the information
 - Using her judgment
 - Understanding the full story
 - Determining whether the investment is “**moving the needle for kids**”
 - Responding to the funder
-

Discovery Questions

Before moving into implementation, several questions still need to be confirmed with the people who own each part of the workflow.

Renée

What makes a school note complete and current?

Priya

How is payment information matched to the correct school and grant?

Stacy

What exact information needs to be visible together before a funder response is considered ready?

These questions help make sure the solution reflects the actual workflow rather than assumptions about how the team works.

Project Focus

This project focuses specifically on **funder reporting**.

Other workflows were explored during discovery, including:

Board Deck

The board deck includes recurring manual work and financial information that can change, but the process is predictable and scheduled.

Index & School Data

Attendance and other public school data may only be released periodically, which can cause information to become stale.

Funder reporting was selected because it showed the clearest gap between **having the information** and being able to **see the whole story when it is needed**.

Key Takeaway

The information needed for funder reporting already exists.

The opportunity is to make it easier to **connect the pieces, identify what needs attention, and get to the whole story without unnecessary waiting and coordination**.

The goal is not to replace the people doing the work.

The goal is to make their work easier.

Project Deliverables

- Discovery research
 - Interview notes
 - Workflow analysis
 - Current-state workflow map
 - Proposed future-state workflow
 - Scope document
 - Presentation
 - Proposed solution and improvement opportunities
-

Author

Bianca Ruiz

AI Foundations / Launchpad Philly

September 2026